



WNHS PROCEDURE	
Transferring MBU Patients to Other Healthcare Providers	
Scope (Staff):	Mental health staff working in WNHS
Scope (Area):	Mother Baby Unit (MBU)
This document should be read in conjunction with the Disclaimer .	

Aim

The procedure aims to ensure that receiving sites for inter hospital transfers are informed prior to the transfer process and receive the relevant clinical documentation from the MBU.

Background

Inter-hospital patient transfer is the process of moving patients between hospitals. Patients from the MBU may require an inter-hospital transfer (external transfer) dependent upon their clinical requirements. The transfer of MBU patients to other hospitals must be conducted in a manner to ensure the safety, continuity of care and recovery of patients involved. The referring service is responsible in following up to ensure a successful transfer of care.

There are two categories of inter-hospital patient transfer. These are:

- Time critical transfers: where a change in the patient's location will immediately impact their condition, including managing the risk of deterioration. This includes urgent transfers such as an emergency via ambulance.
- Non time-critical transfers: where a change in the patient's location will not immediately impact the patient's condition.

Within these two categories patients can be transferred for the purpose of:

- Mental health treatment, assessment or clinical deterioration
- Physical treatment, assessment or clinical deterioration.

For acute deterioration staff should refer to:

- [WA Health Mandatory Policy MP 0171/22 Recognising and Responding to Acute Deterioration Policy](#)
- [NMHS Recognising and Responding to Acute Deterioration \(RRAD\) Policy](#)

- [WNHS Recognising and Responding to Acute Clinical Deterioration \(Physiological and Mental Health\)](#)

Risk

Breach legislative requirements	☐	Impact on Patient Quality of Care	☒
Breach National/State/Mandatory Policy	☒	Impact on Patient Safety	☒
Breach professional standards	☐	Impact financial operations	☐
Damage NMHS reputation	☐	Impact on Staff Safety	☐
Other	☐		

Documentation

- Mental health care is dependent upon good clinical documentation. MBU uses the [Statewide Standardised Clinical Documentation \(SSCD\) - Resources](#) for the management for women and perinatal mental health.
- The [Triage to Discharge](#) document provides a mental health framework to ensure patient treatment, support and discharge plan is accurately communicated over time. For further information on discharge process staff should refer to the [MBU Discharge Procedure](#).

Table 1: Documentation that is required for inter-hospital patient transfer for physical and/or mental health treatment, assessment or clinical deterioration.

Physical and or mental health treatment, assessment or clinical deterioration
Adult Mental Health Physical Examination (SMHMR903)
Adult Mental Health Risk Assessment and Management Plan (SMHMR905)
Adult Mental Health Assessment (SMHMR902)
Adult Mental Health Physical Appearance (SMHMR904)
Adult Mental Health Care Transfer Summary (SMHMR916)
Medication charts
Recent nursing notes
Copies of all relevant Mental Health Act 2014 Forms
Mental Health Patient Transport Risk Rating form (SMHMR994)

1. Process

- The transfer of MBU inpatients to other hospitals for assessment or treatment is the responsibility of the treating psychiatrist or delegate (e.g. After-Hours

Duty Psychiatrist). Where appropriate, any transfer should occur in consultation with the patient, carers/nominated persons and members of the clinical team.

- Arrangements for bed availability/ transfer are to be made between the treating psychiatrist/delegate and/or, during business hours, the Clinical Nurse Manager or Clinical Nurse Consultant.
- Arrangements for the transport of inpatients being transferred are facilitated by CNM/CNC once the transfer details have been finalised by the treating psychiatrist.
- All inpatients are to be risk-assessed before transfer.
- Clinical handover communication is critical to ensuring continuity of care, patient safety and recognising and responding to clinical deterioration. A verbal iSoBAR clinical handover is to be provided to the receiving site by the treating psychiatrist/senior nursing staff highlighting any identified/specific risk. Further information on clinical handover is found in the [MBU Clinical Handover Procedures](#).
- Transport mode and staff requirements for transfer will be guided by the risk assessment.
- All patient documents must be prepared and ready for transport and provided to transport officers/ambulance staff. Preparation of documents must be completed in a timely manner to ensure the inter-hospital patient transfer is not delayed.
- Patient documents must be sent to the receiving site prior to the inter-hospital patient transfer by nursing staff. Patient documents are to also accompany the patient, if requested by the receiving site.
- The treating psychiatrist/ delegate is responsible for notifying relatives/ carers/nominated person of inter-hospital patient transfer.

Patients subject to a Transport Order

For patients that are subject to a transport order (e.g. Form 4a Transport Order or Form 7D Apprehension and Return Order) under the *Mental Health Act 2014* staff should refer to the [DoH WA MP 0063/17 Road-Based Transportation for Mental Health Consumers Policy](#)

Transfer of involuntary patients between authorised hospitals

For the transfer of involuntary patients from one authorised hospital to another please refer to [NMHS MH Transport of Mental Health Consumers Procedure](#).

Related WNHS procedures and guidelines

[Women's and Perinatal Mental Health Referral and Management Guideline](#)
[Patient Transfer and Transport \(including Inter-Hospital Transfer\) Procedure](#)
[NMHS MH Transport of Mental Health Consumers Procedure](#)

Related policies

[Mental Health Act 2014](#)
[Charter of Mental Health Care Principles](#)
[Chief Psychiatrist's Standards for Clinical Care 2015](#)
[Chief Psychiatrist's Guidelines 2015](#)
[NMHS Recognising and Responding to Acute Deterioration \(RRAD\) Policy](#)
[NMHS Safe Transport of Individuals with a Mental Illness Guideline](#)
[Triage to Discharge](#)
[WA Health Mandatory Policy MP 0155/21 State-wide Standardised Clinical Documentation for Mental Health Services](#)
[WA Health Mandatory Policy MP 0171/22 Recognising and Responding to Acute Deterioration Policy](#)
[WNHS Recognising and Responding to Acute Clinical Deterioration \(Physiological and Mental Health\)](#)
[WNHS Patient Transfer and Transport \(including Inter-Hospital Transfer\) Policy](#)

Useful resources (including related forms)

[Statewide Standardised Clinical Documentation \(SSCD\) - Resources](#)
[Mental Health Patient Transport Risk Rating Form](#)

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☒  Std 1: Clinical Governance		☒  Std 5: Comprehensive Care			

NSQHS Standards Applicable:	☒  Std 6: Communicating for Safety	☒  Std 8: Recognising and Responding to Acute Deterioration
Chief Psychiatrist's Standards for Clinical Care	Transfer of Care	
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Version History

<u>Version number</u>	<u>Date</u>	<u>Summary</u>
1	02/08/2016	First published version Title: Clinical Practice Guideline Transport and Transfer of Mental Health Patients under the MHA 2014 merge of MBU and Psych Med guidelines
2.0	November 2017, January 2018	Regular review and updates (other dates unknown)
2.0	January –June 2020	Transport and Transfer of Mental Health Patients Under the Mental Health Act 2014 rescinded
3.0	August 2021	Title change- WNHS Procedure: Transferring MBU patients to other health care providers Updated formatting and content
3.1	June 2025	Three yearly review and update. Amendments include: • minor formatting changes • updated hyperlinks and added relevant related policies Removed: • NMHS Mental Health Policy on Transfer of Patients to Other Hospitals- no longer available • National Standards for Mental Health Services and replaced with Chief Psychiatrist's Standards for Clinical Care to align with NMHS Mental Health documents. Merge of duplication information in Table 1. And changed to: Documentation that is required for inter-hospital patient transfer for physical and/or mental health treatment, assessment or clinical deterioration Added: • Statement: The referring service is responsible in following up to ensure a successful transfer of care. • Mental Health Patient Transport Risk Rating form (SMHMR994) • NMHS MH Transport of Mental Health Consumers Procedure.

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